

In surprisingly good language, a teen called Jessica commented on a Web site: "It's too complicated to send e-mail. I have to go in and type it, and send it, then wait for a reply." Jessica, we do it all the time, and we aren't any the worse for it. We old folks, that is—those of us above, like, 20.

The study also mentions that 60 per cent of American teens have a cell phone and, in more emergent situations, use that gadget, SMSing.

What's the world coming to? (We need to use that phrase at least once in every issue.) But this time we have an answer: we think it's, like, going to, you know, like, the dogs.

Why we say this is that we're noticing a trend: tech and the Internet changing the language of kids, making them irreverent, ridiculously informal, more demanding of everything instant, impatient, and, like, you know, smart-arsed.

Case in point: we have openings here at *Digit*, and here's a sample e-mail from a student to our editor:

Dictionary 2007 Beta

Give me my home in the townie any day;
You call this *dumper* a city? No way!
It's all *conjusted*,
Dirty and *dusted*,
This *inglorified* place that's Bombay!

That might well be Michael's song: it reflects his sentiments about our city, and there's a boo-boo in each line.

We, the copy editors, have our own guilty pleasures: we receive stuff to edit, laugh out sinfully loud at each goof-up, then share them amongst ourselves at lunchtime. Then we laugh loudly again. This month, the sensitive issue of Michael's penchant (wrong usage, but the man would approve) for using the wrong word at the right time was raised. Now he's really a likeable old chap, plus he *might* read this, plus he kills people, so we won't try and be

funny any more—just state the facts.

It went like this: he wrote "longetivity" for "longevity." Raaabo noticed this, did a spell-check right in front of Mikey, and showed him. Mikey was ~~incredible~~ incredulous. The spell-check was performed in Word 2007.

That must have been why he couldn't believe he'd made one of his cool *faux pas*. Here's precisely what he blurted out: "Is that a word in Office 2003 as well?"

Raaabo, very insensitively, began laughing out loud. Then he shared it with Ram, who, no less insensitive, wrote this.

Copy Editors are Ghost Writers. Thankless job. Ever see an article that says "By Joe Browne, Edited by John Smith"? So just this one time, we get to use this space. But we're not telling Michael—and please don't spill the peas.

DIGIT DIARY

"Hi man—heres the stuff you asked me to send over. I know one of them is a bit crappy—I sort of like wrote it in a rush—but the other two should be just ok, tell me what you think of them"

Notice the irreverence? The hurried tone? The brattishness? They're all becoming like that. And

they're calling anyone over 20 "old." What will they turn out like when they become, well, responsible adults? Will they, like, hold corporate meetings via IM?

Anyway, the bottom-line: in 2002, *The Guardian* hosted a poetry competition, where only poems written through text messages were eligible.

The winning poem read:

"I left my pictur on th ground wher u walk so that someday if th sun was jst right & th rain didnt wash me awa u might c me out of th corner of yr i & pic me up"
Don't, like, ask us about the non-winning poems. ☒

Blog WATCH

Leopard vs. Vista is the topic of many blog posts—as we'd expected. And everyone's talking about Apple's new offerings and Nintendo's Wii, of course

Yasser Dahab
<http://snipurl.com/nov001>
(<http://theappleblog.com/2006/10/08/google-next-free-mac/>)

Google: The Next (free) .Mac

...Google sweetens the deal with their hosted solutions, providing anyone with a web domain the option of using Gmail, Google Talk, and Google Calendar with their own email address. You can also browse your RSS subscriptions from within Gmail, a trick I wish Apple's Mail would've learned long ago...

...It seems to me that Apple has doomed .Mac by forgetting to uphold three relatively simple rules: Listen to your users. Deliver on your promises. Make your die-hard fans feel special.

Steven J. Vaughan-Nichols
<http://snipurl.com/nov003>
(<http://desktoplinux.com/articles/AT5194932909.html>)
Firefox 2.0 RC 2: better, not perfect

The anti-phishing feature is first rate. With it working, which it is the default in this release, it automatically checks that a site really is the site that it's claiming to be, by comparing the website's information with a list of known phishing sites. If you really want to go on to the bogus site, you can also do that.

Marshall Kirpatrick
<http://snipurl.com/nov002>
(<http://www.techcrunch.com/2006/10/09/ten-things-i-wish-ie-7-was-about-to-deliver/>)

Ten Things I Wish IE 7 Was About to Deliver

...There are a lot of shortcomings still. Over all it's an improvement and I'm thankful that if nothing else tabbed browsing will be spread around the world. Some people might say I'm just looking for feature overload, but there are clearly a lot of new features already being added. I'd just like to see a few more and better implementation of what's coming in this release.

Jeremy Zawodny
<http://snipurl.com/nov005>
(<http://jeremy.zawodny.com/blog/archives/007665.html>)

Hit counter 2.0 or "Web 2.0 Metrics"

...At one time it was common to see a hit counter on every page, but this is no longer the case for several reasons:

- They have been replaced (or augmented) by more complicated web analytics methodologies that give the webmaster a better overall picture of site traffic besides a simple, perpetually increasing number...

... But Ajax is only part of the reason pageviews are obsolete. Another one is RSS. About half the readers of this blog do so via RSS.